

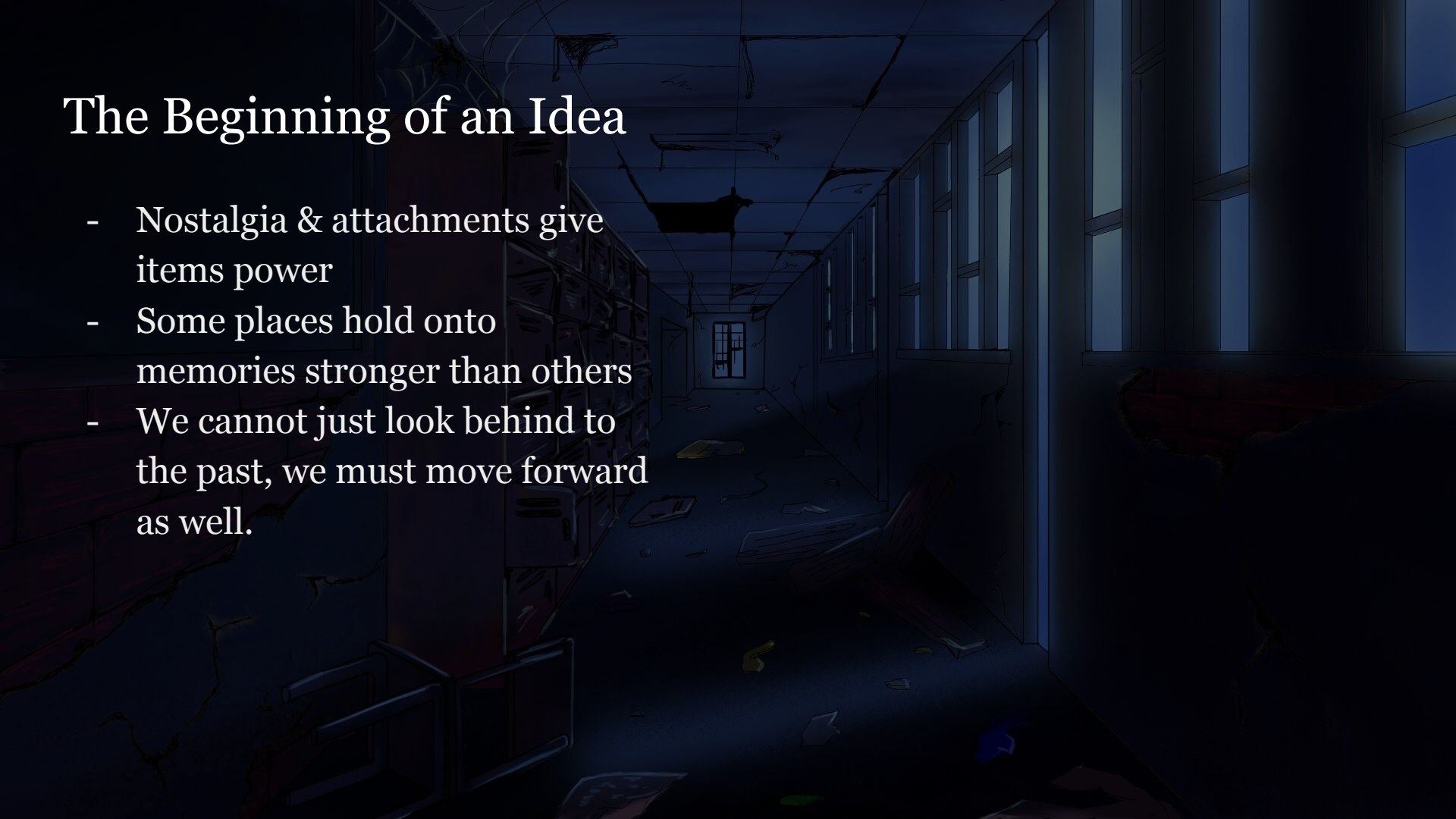
Game Jam: The Things We Leave Behind...

*Proudly and Profoundly
Presented by: U9
[Not going for CSIT]*



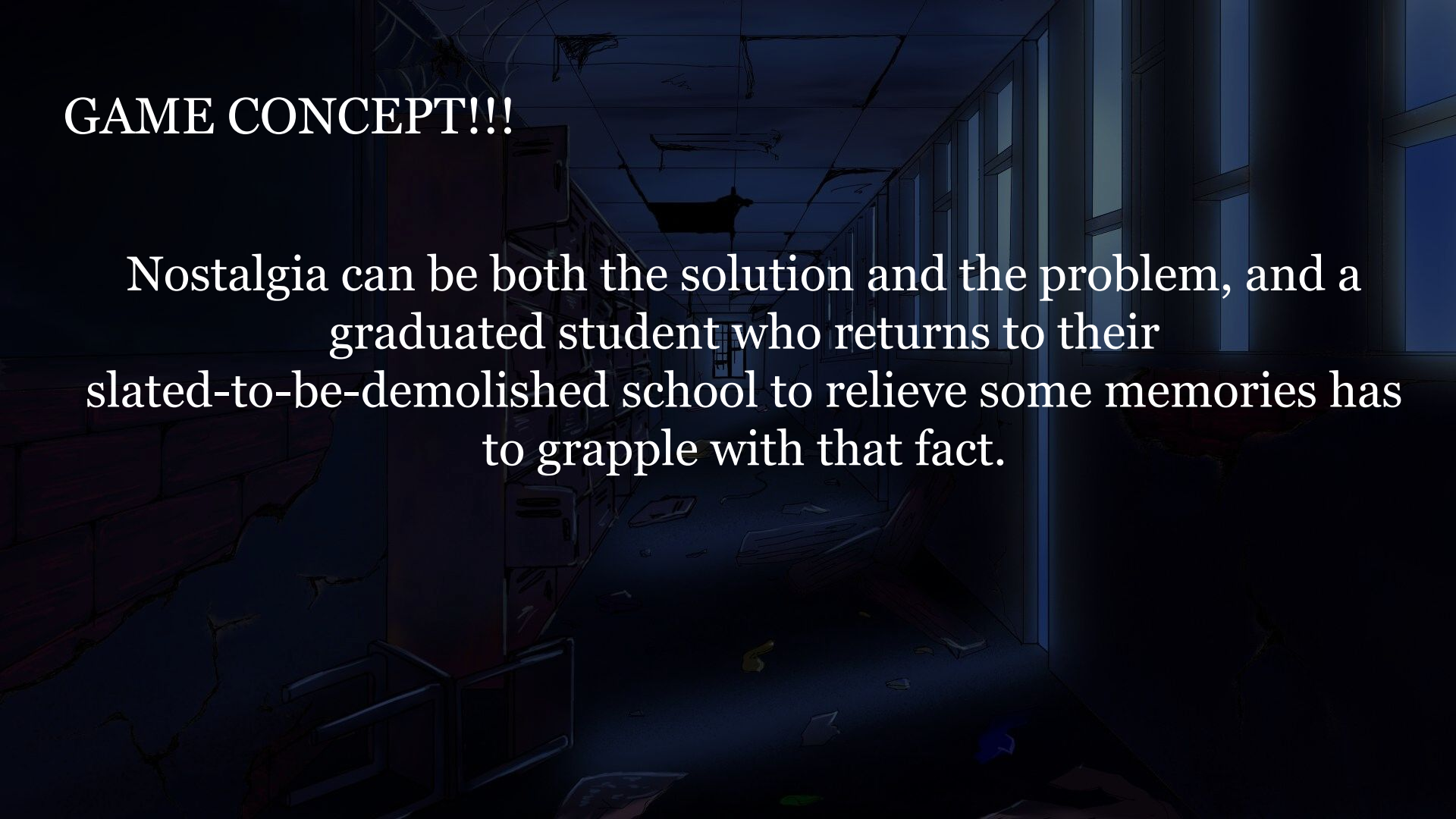
The Beginning of an Idea

- Nostalgia & attachments give items power
- Some places hold onto memories stronger than others
- We cannot just look behind to the past, we must move forward as well.

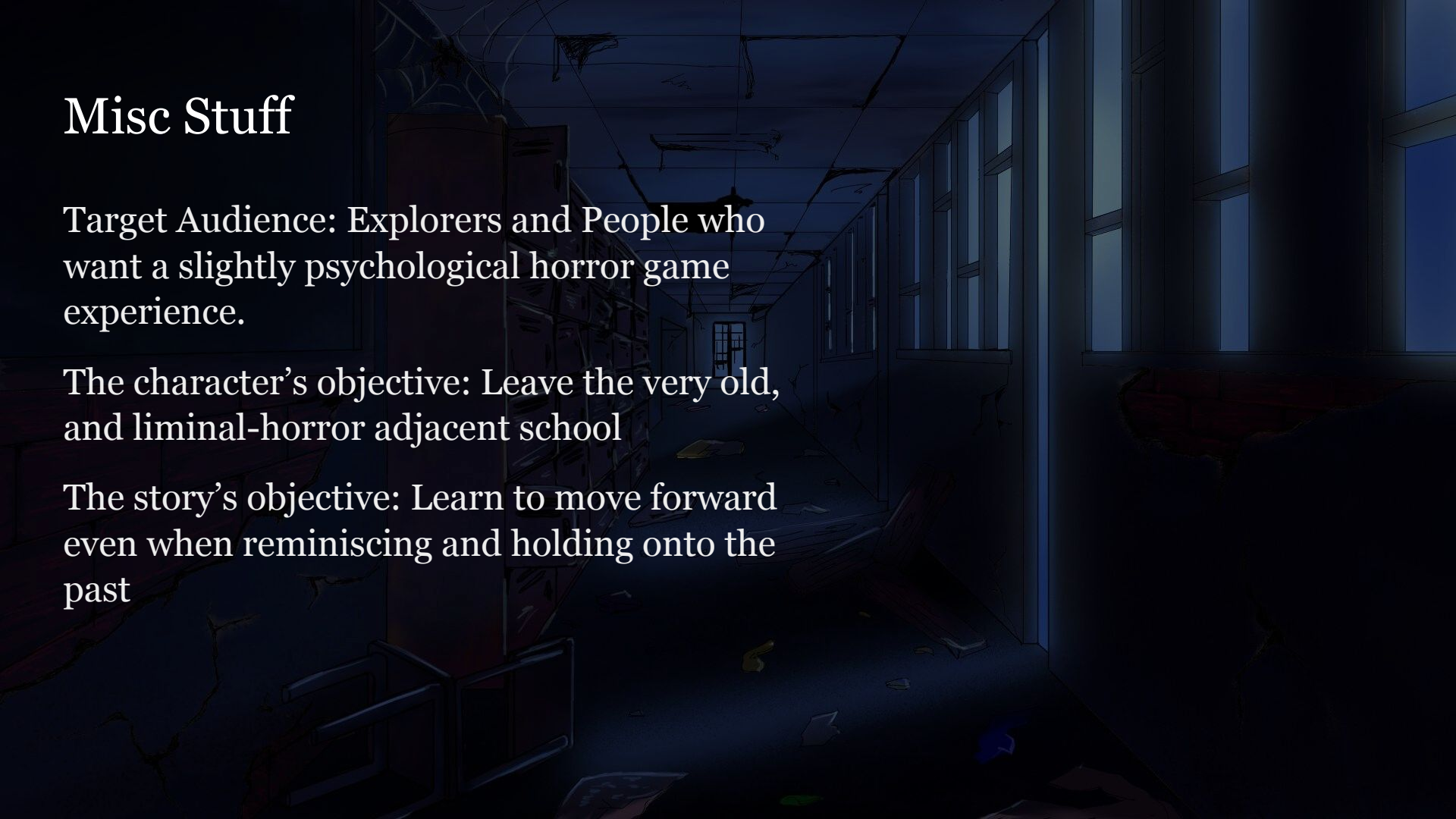


GAME CONCEPT!!!

Nostalgia can be both the solution and the problem, and a graduated student who returns to their slated-to-be-demolished school to relieve some memories has to grapple with that fact.



Misc Stuff



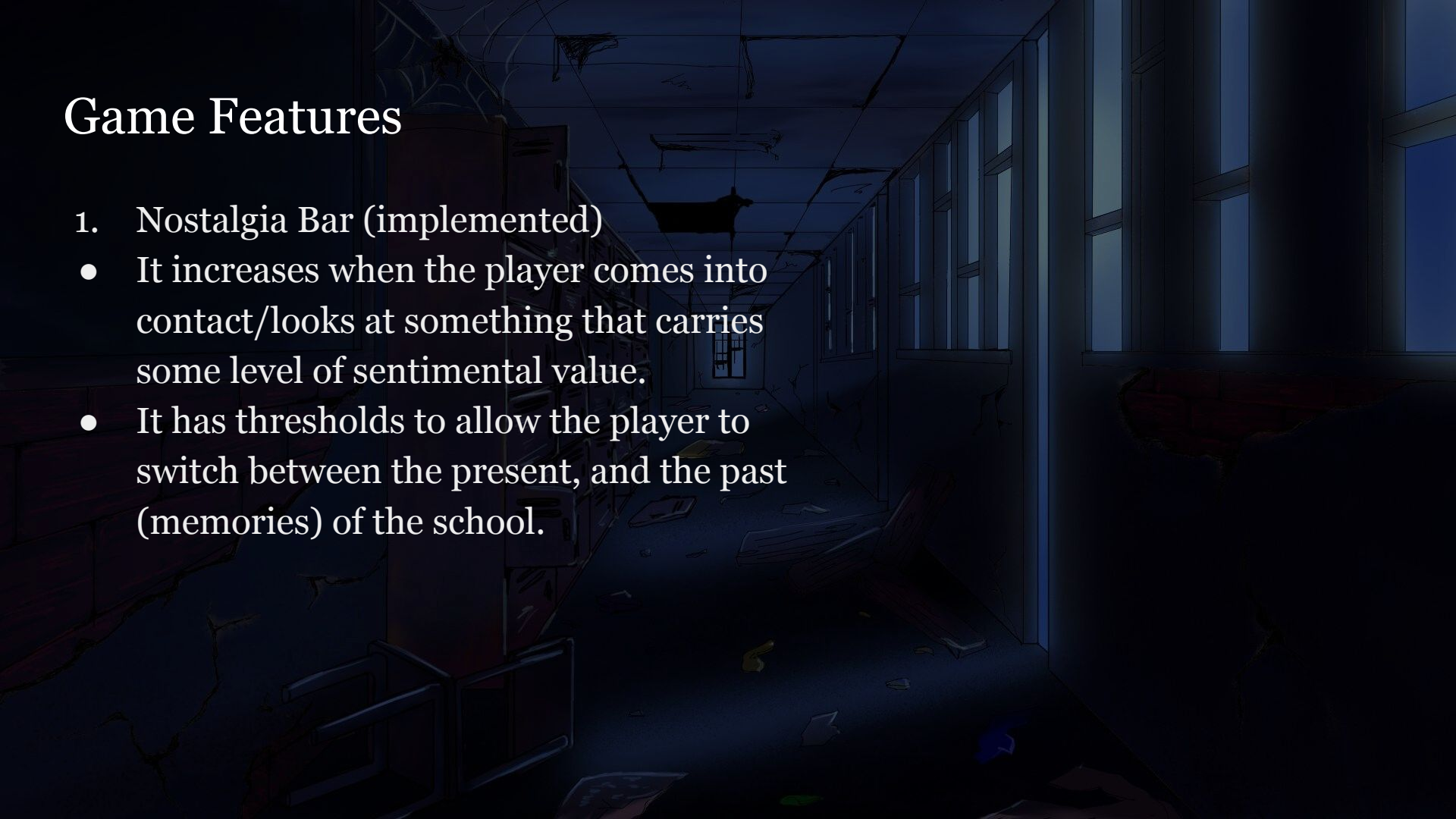
Target Audience: Explorers and People who want a slightly psychological horror game experience.

The character's objective: Leave the very old, and liminal-horror adjacent school

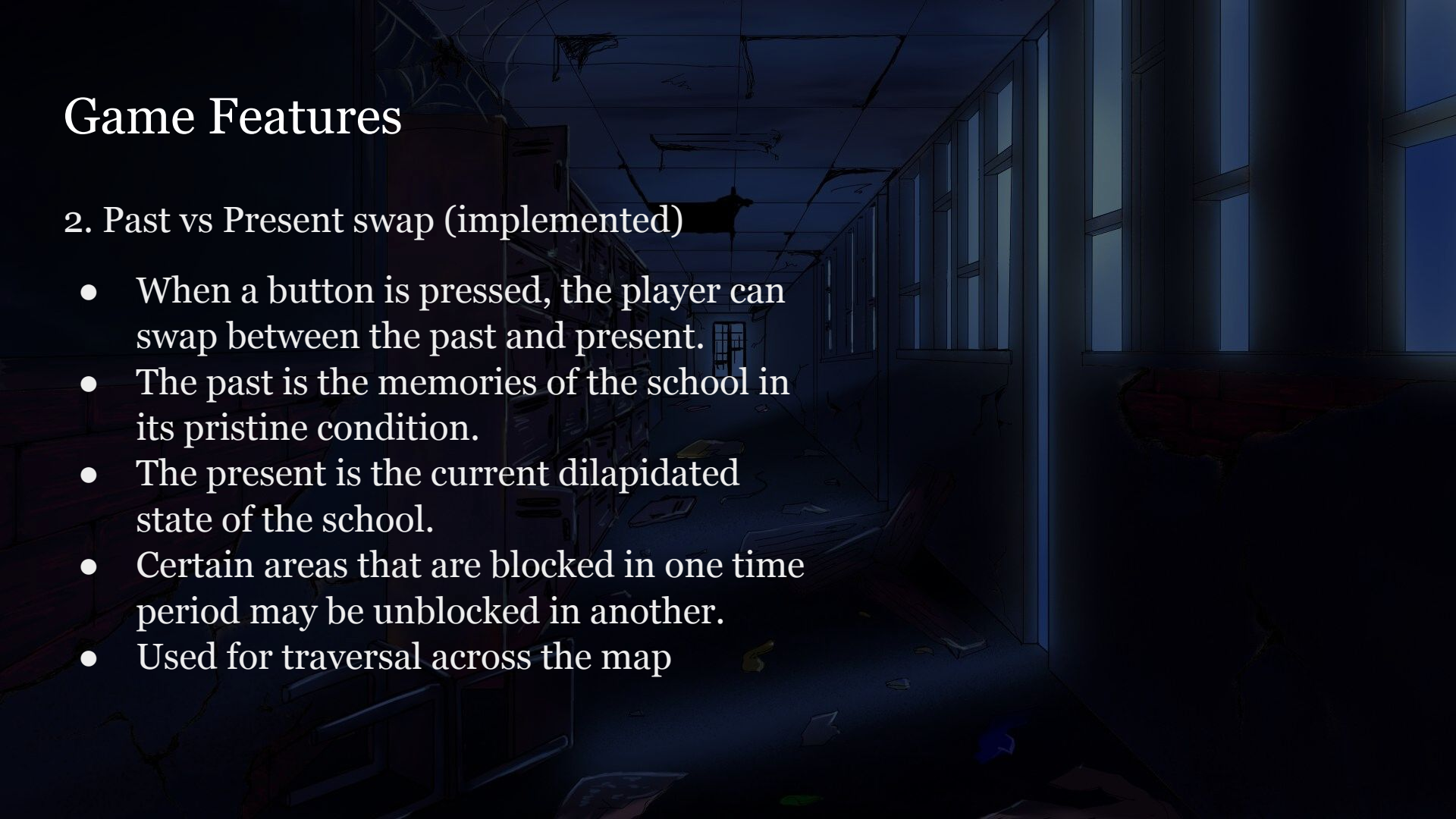
The story's objective: Learn to move forward even when reminiscing and holding onto the past

Game Features

1. Nostalgia Bar (implemented)
 - It increases when the player comes into contact/looks at something that carries some level of sentimental value.
 - It has thresholds to allow the player to switch between the present, and the past (memories) of the school.



Game Features



2. Past vs Present swap (implemented)

- When a button is pressed, the player can swap between the past and present.
- The past is the memories of the school in its pristine condition.
- The present is the current dilapidated state of the school.
- Certain areas that are blocked in one time period may be unblocked in another.
- Used for traversal across the map

What could've been if there's more time

1. Puzzle mechanics (lockpicking etc.)
2. Enemies that are from corrupted memories + roguelite combat style
3. A chase sequence + fetch quests at the end
4. An actual slow-burn story that follows story conventions
5. More atmospheric conditions
6. More story elements even within the items with connotations to sentiments and memory.

Design Choices (I): Art

- Warmer and brighter colours for the past, contrast with the cooler and colours for the present.
- 2D for the game because we are trying to focus more on the story rather than the straight horror. (Also we don't have time to figure out the entire architecture of the school)
- Art style should be pixel and largely simple to look at and understand, since we are looking back on simpler times.

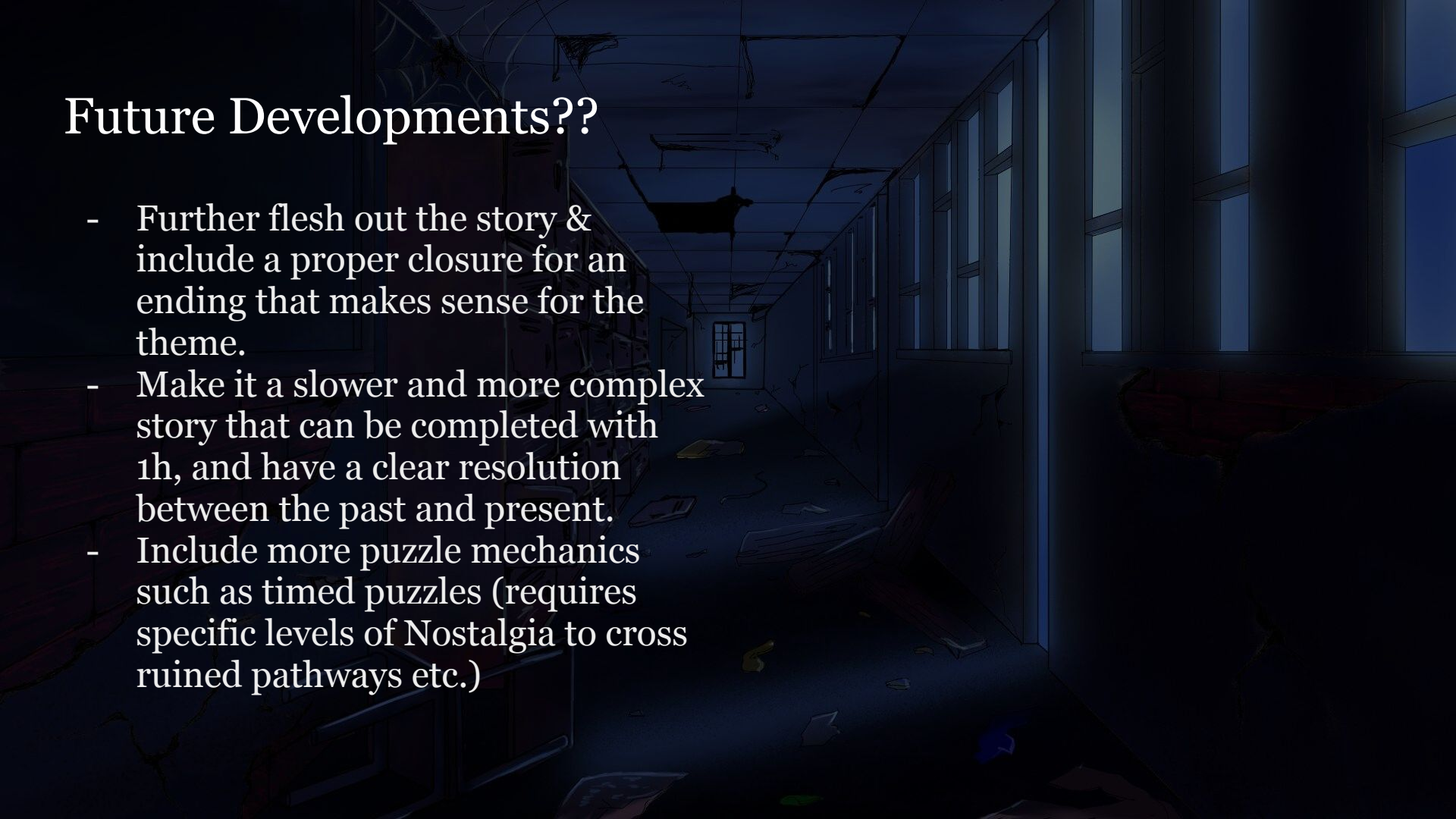


Design Choices (II): Music

- Start Music: Mellow, lonely, a bit hopeful/nostalgic tone of music 
- Climax Music: Very dramatic, fast-paced with wood blocks sounding like the ticking of a clock. This is to emphasise the short amount of time the player has to beat the enemies. 
- Ending: As the screen fades to black and the final story texts appear, the first and second parts of the music play, acting as buildup to the finale. Then the last part that is most dramatic plays as the credits roll. 
- Overall using some hopeful-sounding chord progressions (especially in the final track) to give the player the feeling that they have finally acquired what they have been chasing throughout the game: freedom and relief from nostalgia that has been holding them back from moving on with their lives.

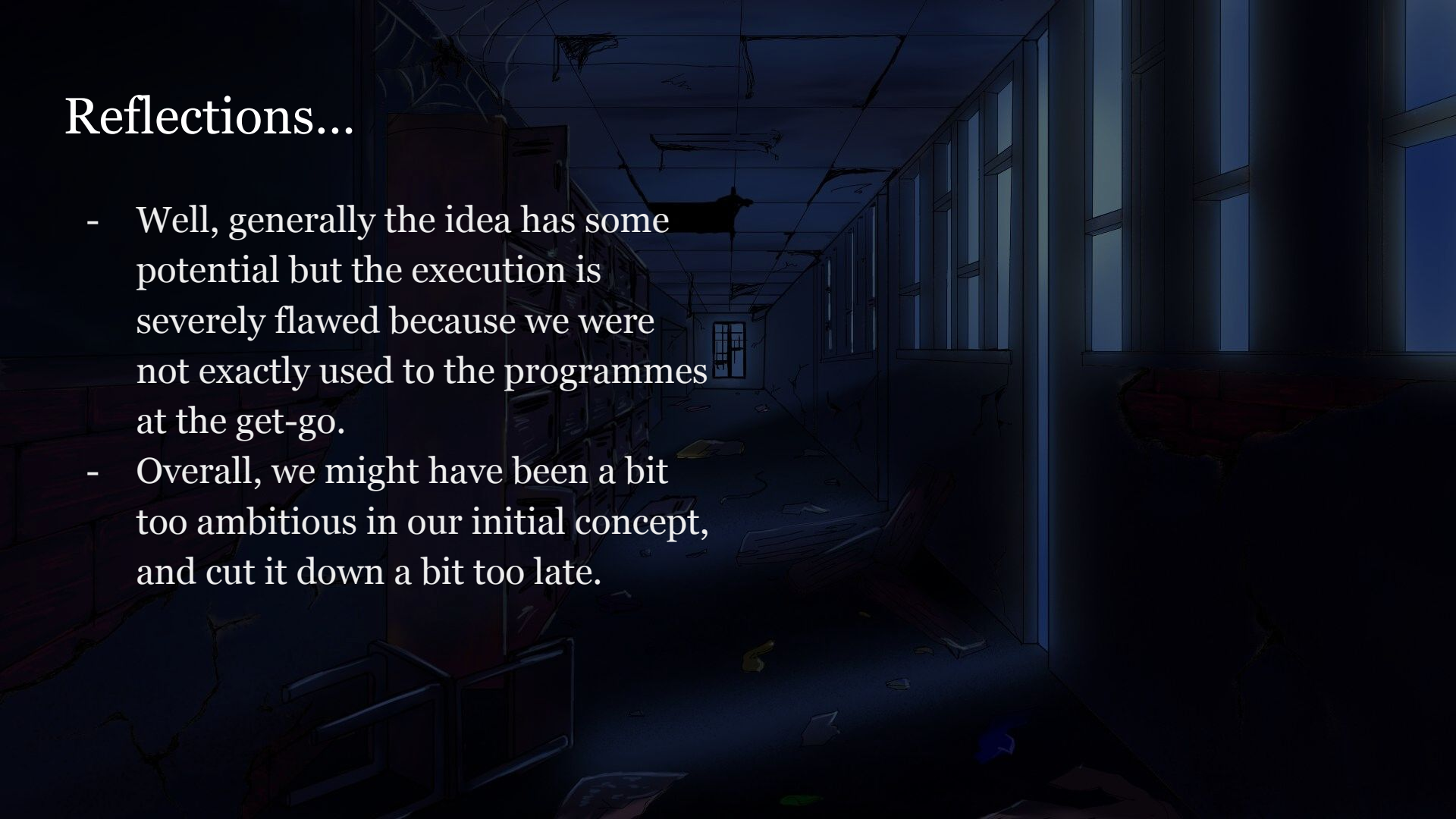
Future Developments??

- Further flesh out the story & include a proper closure for an ending that makes sense for the theme.
- Make it a slower and more complex story that can be completed with 1h, and have a clear resolution between the past and present.
- Include more puzzle mechanics such as timed puzzles (requires specific levels of Nostalgia to cross ruined pathways etc.)



Reflections...

- Well, generally the idea has some potential but the execution is severely flawed because we were not exactly used to the programmes at the get-go.
- Overall, we might have been a bit too ambitious in our initial concept, and cut it down a bit too late.



Overall?

